

Ashwin scales Mt. 500

9} The number of bowlers who now have the distinction of reaching 500 wickets during their Test career. India's R. Ashwin became the latest to join this elite group on the second day of the Rajkot Test match on 16 March 2024. He thus became the second Indian after Anil Kumble (619) and the third off-spinner after Sri Lanka's M. Muralitharan and Australian Nathan Lyon.

Quickest to reach the 500th Test wicket (in fewest Tests) – the complete list

Tests	Bowler	For	Achieved on	Wkts	Ave.	S/R	Age
87	M. Muralitharan	SL	16 Mar 2004	500	22.78	59.04	31y-334d
98	R. Ashwin	Ind	16 Feb 2024	500	23.95	51.49	37y-152d
105	Anil Kumble	Ind	11 Mar 2006	501	28.88	65.79	35y-145d
108	Shane Warne	Aus	12 Mar 2004	501	25.51	60.32	34y-181d
110	Glenn McGrath	Aus	21 Jul 2005	504	21.12	50.83	35y-162d
123	Nathan Lyon	Aus	17 Dec 2023	501	30.86	63.10	36y-27d
129	Courtney Walsh	WI	19 Mar 2001	504	24.56	57.56	38y-140d
129	James Anderson	Eng	8 Sep 2017	506	27.39	55.85	35y-40d
140	Stuart Broad	Eng	28 Jul 2020	501	27.95	56.77	34y-34d

Note: The above career figures are updated at the end of the innings of the match during which milestone was achieved.

51.46} R. Ashwin's career bowling strike-rate at the end of the Rajkot Test match is now the best by any bowler with 500 or more wickets in a Test career. Behind him is Australian Glenn McGrath, whose bowling strike-rate is the closest to Ashwin.

Best career bowling career strike rates among the nine bowlers with 500-plus Test wickets

S/R	Bowler	For	Tests	Wkts	Ave.	R/O
51.46	R. Ashwin	Ind	98	501	23.94	2.79
51.95	Glenn McGrath	Aus	124	563	21.64	2.50
55.05	M. Muralitharan	SL	133	800	22.73	2.48
55.79	Stuart Broad	Eng	167	604	27.68	2.98
56.98	James Anderson	Eng	185	696	26.51	2.79

3} The number of players who have the distinction of doing the double of 3000 runs and 500 wickets during their Test career. Incidentally, Ashwin is now the quickest to do this in the fewest Test matches (98).

Players with 3000-plus runs and 500-plus wickets in Test cricket history

Player	For	Tests	Runs	Ave.	Wkts	Ave.	Achieved in	
							Test#	Date
Shane Warne	Aus	145	3154	17.33	708	25.42	142	4 Dec 2006
Stuart Broad	Eng	167	3662	18.04	604	27.68	140	28 Jul 2020
R. Ashwin	Ind	98	3308	26.68	501	23.94	98	16 Mar 2024

250} The number of left-handed victims claimed by R. Ashwin in Test cricket. He becomes the first bowler in Test cricket history to achieve this milestone. Way behind him is England's Jimmy Anderson, who has 216 left-handed victims.

Bowlers claiming wickets of left-handed batters on most occasions during their Test career

Bowler	For	LHB	RHB	Total wickets	%LHB	Matches
R. Ashwin	Ind	250	251	501	49.90	98
James Anderson	Eng	217	479	696	31.18	185
Stuart Broad	Eng	193	411	604	31.95	167
M. Muralitharan	SL	191	609	800	23.88	133
Nathan Lyon	Aus	184	333	517	35.59	127



India's Ravichandran Ashwin. VIJAY SONEJI